



**"[PARLIAMENT] CANNOT ...
LEGISLATE ON THE HUMAN
RACE, ON WOMEN AND ON
CHILDREN, WITHOUT US."**

CLARA CAMPOAMOR, IN *THE FEMALE VOTE AND ME*, 1936

whose focus was on individual states, so in 1916 she formed the National Women's Party. Together with other campaigners, such as Doris Stevens, Paul staged a series of protests that eventually wore down governmental opposition and won public support. She initiated nonviolent pickets outside of the White House in 1917, and rallies of women bearing banners demanding the right to vote. Various women (including, in 1917, a group called the "Silent Sentinels") picketed six days a week for two years, until the administration passed the 19th amendment in 1919.

Canadian women (barring those in the province of Quebec and indigenous women) had the right to vote by 1918, but made yet more significant gains in the years that followed. In the so-called Persons case, a group of women dubbed the "Famous Five" by the media—Nellie McClung, Henrietta Muir Edwards, Irene Parlby, Louise McKinney, and Emily Murphy—petitioned against the vague wording of the British North America Act of 1867. The act implied that women were not "persons" under the law, thereby preventing them from participating fully in politics. Thanks to the work of the Famous Five, in 1929 the British Privy Council voted that women were indeed "persons" and could become senators.

Women in southern Europe were not granted full voting rights until much later. Clara Campoamor,

a young Spanish lawyer who went on to become her country's first female magistrate, was largely responsible for ensuring that suffrage for women was enshrined in the Spanish constitution of 1931. Across the border in France and Italy, women would have to wait almost until the end of World War II to get the vote, which was finally granted in 1945, decades ahead of Switzerland, where women won the vote in 1971. Suffrage outside of Europe also occurred at a varying rate. Azerbaijan became the first majority Muslim country to grant women the vote in 1921, yet Saudi Arabia did not follow suit until 2015, nearly one hundred years later.



▲ Suppressing suffragists

Antisuffrage labels such as this one were common in France and other parts of Europe. Opponents to female suffrage claimed that women were uninterested in voting. Such opinions persisted in countries that were slow to give women the vote.



◀ Message on wheels

This ordinary delivery wagon was used by US suffragist Lucy Stone. She traveled around in it, stopping to make speeches and distribute copies of the *Woman's Journal*. The wagon was later painted with slogans by the suffragists who used it after Stone.